

## MOCK 14: IIMB VA

**Q1:** Five statements are given below, four of which follow a common thread.

1. With advances in natural language processing, legal firms are now able to review contracts for risk clauses in a fraction of the time previously required.
2. Blockchain-based smart contracts promise to automate execution and enforcement without relying on intermediaries across industries.
3. Predictive text-mining algorithms have already begun assisting paralegals in flagging inconsistencies across lengthy case files.
4. The integration of artificial intelligence into legal practice is significantly reshaping how firms handle documentation and research.
5. Machine learning models trained on historical case data enable lawyers to anticipate likely rulings and refine their arguments accordingly.

Identify the statement that does not follow the common thread.

- A) Statement 4
- B) Statement 2
- C) Statement 5
- D) Statement 3

**Correct Answer: B) Statement 2**

**Explanation:** Statements 1, 3, 4, and 5 are all specifically about artificial intelligence and machine learning being applied within legal practice, while statement 2 is about blockchain and smart contracts, which is a different underlying technology built around automation and enforcement rather than AI-driven analysis, even though it sits in the same general legal-tech space.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

A) Statement 4 is the general framing statement tying AI directly to transformation in legal practice, so it belongs squarely within the thread.

C) Statement 5 is about machine learning predicting case outcomes, which is a clear extension of the same AI thread running through the other statements.

D) Statement 3 describes text-mining algorithms assisting paralegals, which fits naturally with the AI-in-legal-practice thread shared by the rest.

**Q2:** Examine the following statement:

The diplomat remained circumspect throughout the negotiations, weighing every word before it left her mouth.

Choose the option that best uses the underlined word in a context similar to how it is used in the statement.

- A) The witness remained circumspect during cross-examination, carefully measuring each answer before giving it.
- B) The child remained circumspect after being caught, immediately admitting to everything without hesitation.
- C) The comedian remained circumspect on stage, blurting out whatever came to mind for laughs.
- D) The tourist remained circumspect at the market, haggling loudly over every single price.

**Correct Answer: A) The witness remained circumspect during cross-examination, carefully measuring each answer before giving it.**

**Explanation:** The original statement uses "circumspect" to describe someone being cautious and deliberate about what they say, weighing their words carefully before speaking, and the witness measuring each answer during cross-examination captures that exact same careful, guarded behaviour.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- B) Immediately admitting everything without hesitation is the opposite of being careful or guarded, so this doesn't match the caution the word actually describes.
- C) Blurting things out for laughs is spontaneous and unfiltered, which runs directly against the deliberate, measured behaviour the word is pointing to.
- D) Haggling loudly over every price is brash and unrestrained, nowhere close to the quiet, careful caution "circumspect" is meant to convey.

**Q3:**

From the options given below, identify the pair of adjectives in the following statement.

In the sepulchral, cavernous hall, he lingered pensively and inexorably, letting his equanimity and stoicism steer his verdicts, as trepidation coalesced around him in the flickering candlelight.

- A) pensively / inexorably
- B) equanimity / stoicism
- C) sepulchral / cavernous
- D) cavernous / pensively

**Correct Answer: C) sepulchral / cavernous**

**Explanation:** Sepulchral and cavernous are both describing the hall, telling us what kind of hall it is, which is exactly what an adjective does, while the other tricky looking words in the sentence are either adverbs or nouns dressed up to look similar.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) Pensively and inexorably both end in "ly" and describe how he lingered, which makes them adverbs, not adjectives.
- B) Equanimity and stoicism are abstract qualities being referred to as things in themselves, which makes them nouns, not words describing another noun.

D) Cavernous is genuinely an adjective, but pensively is an adverb describing the manner of lingering, so this pairing mixes the two different word types.

**Q4:**

The following sentences are in jumbled order. Arrange them in the most logical sequence to form a meaningful paragraph.

A. However, funding models remain fragmented, since most citizen science initiatives rely on short-term grants rather than sustained institutional backing.

B. As Silvertown noted, in the 1990s participation was largely confined to birdwatching societies, but by the 2000s data quality concerns had already sparked debate among professional researchers.

C. In this respect, platforms that pair volunteer contributions with automated verification tools may help address some of these long-standing quality concerns.

D. The involvement of amateur volunteers in scientific data collection is not a recent phenomenon.

A) ADBC

B) DBAC

C) BDCA

D) BCDA

**Correct Answer: B) DBAC**

**Explanation:** D opens with the general claim that volunteer involvement isn't new, B follows by tracing the historical timeline from the 90s into the 2000s, A then pivots with "however" to raise the funding problem, and C closes by proposing a solution to the concerns raised earlier, so DBAC builds a clear beginning, middle, and resolution.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

A) ADBC opens with the funding contrast before any historical context has been established, so the "however" in A has nothing to push back against yet.

C) BDCA puts the historical timeline first but then jumps to the solution in C before the funding problem in A has even been raised, leaving the "in this respect" in C pointing at nothing.

D) BCDA starts fine with the history in B but then jumps straight to the solution in C before the general opening claim in D or the funding issue in A have been introduced, breaking the logical build-up entirely.

**Q5:** Select an option to complete the given sentence.

If the board \_\_\_\_\_ the warning signs earlier, the merger \_\_\_\_\_ before the regulatory deadline, but instead everything collapsed.

A) had heeded, would have been finalized

B) heeded, would be finalized

C) would heed, had been finalized

D) heeds, will be finalized

**Correct Answer: A) had heeded, would have been finalized**

**Explanation:** This is a third conditional describing a hypothetical past that didn't happen, so it needs "had + past participle" in the if-clause and "would have + past participle" in the main clause to correctly express an unreal past condition and its unreal past result.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

B) "Heeded" without "had" and "would be" without "have" shifts this into a second conditional structure, which describes a hypothetical present or future, not a missed opportunity in the past.

C) This reverses the required tense pattern entirely, putting the unreal past marker in the wrong clause while the if-clause loses the "had" it actually needs.

D) This uses present and future tense forms, which describes a real, possible future condition, not a hypothetical past event that already failed to happen.

**Q6:** Choose the appropriate idiom that is closest to the underlined segment in the following.

The scheme she'd used to oust her rivals ended up costing her the very position she'd fought for.

- A) hoist with one's own petard
- B) cut from the same cloth
- C) throw someone under the bus
- D) play devil's advocate

**Correct Answer: A) hoist with one's own petard**

**Explanation:** This idiom describes being harmed by one's own scheme, which matches her losing the position because of the very tactic she used to get there.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

B) "Cut from the same cloth" means two people share similar qualities, which has nothing to do with a scheme backfiring.

C) "Throw someone under the bus" means sacrificing someone else to save yourself, but here she's the one harmed by her own plan, not someone sacrificing another.

D) "Play devil's advocate" means arguing an opposing view for debate's sake, unrelated to a scheme turning back on its creator.

**Reading Comprehension:**

In an era besotted with its own algorithmic infallibility, humanity has reduced knowledge into a tabulated commodity, search rankings, citation counts, engagement metrics, and attention curves. The ancient discipline of inquiry has been usurped by the industry of information; universities resemble content factories, and the scholar, once a custodian of curiosity, now negotiates uneasily between output and virality. Productivity has become the new orthodoxy. In chasing endless data, we seem to have forgotten how to think.

Dr. Amara Voss, a distinguished linguist celebrated for her foundational work on semantic drift, relinquished her tenured position after recognizing a paradox academia refused to confront,

that wisdom cannot be indexed and understanding cannot be manufactured through aggregation or automation. She retreated to a remote archipelago where language was preserved through oral tradition, storytelling, and communal memory. There she discovered that comprehension was not an act of accumulation but of assimilation, a slow absorption of meaning into lived experience.

Decades later, as institutions buckled under an epidemic of intellectual fatigue, a pervasive exhaustion unmoved by any algorithm, governments began mandating literacy quotas, prescribing reading targets as though insight could be legislated into existence. The irony was stark: contemplation turned into a checklist, and curiosity became a metric on institutional dashboards.

In her final manuscript, *The Architecture of Understanding*, Dr. Voss argued that modern civilization's deepest fallacy was epistemological, the delusion that knowledge could exist apart from meaning. Her ideas, dismissed once as impractical nostalgia, later sparked a quiet reformation in educational philosophy.

**Q7:** As used in the passage, which is the best synonym for "besotted"?

- A) skeptical
- B) infatuated
- C) indifferent
- D) apprehensive

**Correct Answer: B) infatuated**

**Explanation:** The passage describes an era "besotted with its own algorithmic infallibility," meaning society has become blindly, excessively enamored with technology's perceived perfection, which matches the sense of being infatuated to the point of losing judgment.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) Skeptical implies doubt or distrust, which is the opposite of the uncritical enthusiasm the passage is actually describing.
- C) Indifferent would mean not caring at all, but the passage describes an intense, almost obsessive fixation, not a lack of interest.
- D) Apprehensive suggests worry or unease, which contradicts the overconfident, celebratory tone the passage attributes to this technological infatuation.

**Q8:** The tone of the passage's final paragraph can best be described as

- A) purely celebratory, praising institutions for adopting her ideas immediately
- B) neutral and purely descriptive, without any implied judgment
- C) critical of contemporary systems while validating the eventual impact of her ideas
- D) dismissive of Dr. Voss's contributions to educational philosophy

**Correct Answer: C) critical of contemporary systems while validating the eventual impact of her ideas**

**Explanation:** The passage criticizes the reduction of contemplation into a checklist and curiosity into a metric, while also noting that her once-dismissed ideas eventually sparked a genuine reformation, which is a mix of critique and validation rather than a purely one-sided tone.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) The paragraph is far from purely celebratory, since it opens by criticizing how institutions turned contemplation into something mechanical and reductive.
- B) The language used, like calling something ironic or a fallacy, carries clear judgment, so this can't be read as neutral or free of implied opinion.
- D) The passage explicitly says her ideas sparked a quiet reformation, which is the opposite of dismissing her contributions as insignificant.

**Q9:** Which of the following best describes the grammatical function of the phrase "a pervasive exhaustion unmoved by any algorithm" in the passage?

- A) It functions as the main subject of an independent clause.
- B) It functions as a relative clause modifying "institutions."
- C) It functions as a subordinate clause expressing cause.
- D) It functions as an appositive renaming "an epidemic of intellectual fatigue."

**Correct Answer: D) It functions as an appositive renaming "an epidemic of intellectual fatigue."**

**Explanation:** The phrase is set off by commas immediately after "an epidemic of intellectual fatigue" and restates the same idea in different words rather than introducing new grammatical action, which is exactly what an appositive does.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) The phrase has no verb of its own and cannot stand as an independent clause, since it depends entirely on the noun it's describing.
- B) A relative clause would need a relative pronoun like "which" or "that" connecting it to "institutions," but here it directly follows and renames a different noun phrase entirely.
- C) The phrase doesn't introduce any cause-and-effect relationship or contain a subordinating conjunction, it simply restates and elaborates on the noun beside it.

**Q10:** Based on the passage, which of the following can be inferred about Dr. Voss's central argument in her final manuscript?

- A) She believed institutions should abandon literacy programs entirely.
- B) She believed oral tradition is scientifically superior to written records.
- C) She believed government mandates were the only way to restore intellectual depth.
- D) She believed knowledge and meaning are inseparable, and treating them as separate is a fundamental error.

**Correct Answer: D) She believed knowledge and meaning are inseparable, and treating them as separate is a fundamental error.**

**Explanation:** The passage explicitly states her argument was that civilization's deepest fallacy was the delusion that knowledge could exist apart from meaning, which directly supports the idea that she saw the two as inherently linked.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

A) The passage criticizes how literacy quotas were legislated and reduced to a checklist, but it never suggests she wanted such programs eliminated altogether.

B) The passage describes her personal retreat to a place where oral tradition was practiced, but it never claims she argued oral tradition was scientifically superior to writing.

C) The passage actually criticizes government mandates as ironic and reductive, which contradicts the idea that she saw them as the solution.

**Reading Comprehension:**

Financial exclusion continues to disproportionately affect rural populations in low-income regions, revealing a persistent and deeply entrenched disparity in access to formal banking infrastructure. Expanding access to credit and savings mechanisms is therefore not merely an economic imperative but a crucial developmental strategy that contributes directly to poverty alleviation and the broader attainment of inclusive growth targets.

Current global estimates indicate that nearly a third of adults in developing economies remain unbanked, with rural women constituting a disproportionate share of this population. This disparity is often rooted in structural barriers such as the absence of physical bank branches, prohibitive documentation requirements and deeply ingrained distrust of formal financial institutions cultivated through generations of exploitative moneylending practices. Additionally, limited digital literacy and inconsistent mobile network coverage severely restrict the reach of emerging fintech solutions intended to bridge this gap.

Exclusion from formal financial systems tends to compound existing economic vulnerabilities. It can restrict access to emergency credit, diminish entrepreneurial opportunities, and, in some contexts, entrench cycles of intergenerational poverty. Conversely, expanded financial inclusion has a demonstrable multiplier effect. When households gain access to reliable savings instruments, they exhibit measurably greater resilience during periods of economic volatility and contribute to broader regional stability.

In many underserved regions, microfinance institutions have begun deploying community-based agents, often local residents themselves, to bridge the trust deficit separating rural households from formal banks. Their embeddedness within these communities positions them as credible intermediaries and catalysts of gradual behavioural change.

**Q11:** Which of the following best describes the grammatical function of the phrase "often local residents themselves" in the passage?

A) It functions as an appositive providing additional information about "community-based agents."

B) It functions as the main verb phrase of an independent clause.

- C) It functions as a relative clause modifying "microfinance institutions."
- D) It functions as a subordinating clause expressing contrast.

**Correct Answer: A) It functions as an appositive providing additional information about "community-based agents."**

**Explanation:** The phrase is set off by commas right after "community-based agents" and adds extra descriptive detail about who these agents are without introducing a new action, which is exactly what an appositive does.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- B) The phrase has no verb of its own, so it cannot function as the main verb phrase of any clause.
- C) A relative clause would need a relative pronoun connecting it to "microfinance institutions," but this phrase directly follows and describes a different noun phrase entirely.
- D) There's no subordinating conjunction here and no contrast being introduced, the phrase simply elaborates on the noun right before it.

**Q12:** Based on the passage, which of the following can be inferred about the role of community-based agents?

- A) They primarily replace the need for digital literacy training in rural areas.
- B) They are exclusively employed by government-run banks rather than microfinance institutions.
- C) Their local presence helps address distrust that formal institutions alone have struggled to overcome.
- D) Their main function is to enforce stricter documentation requirements on rural households.

**Correct Answer: C) Their local presence helps address distrust that formal institutions alone have struggled to overcome.**

**Explanation:** The passage states these agents bridge the trust deficit separating rural households from formal banks and describes their embeddedness in the community as making them credible intermediaries, which directly supports this inference.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) The passage never claims these agents replace digital literacy training, it discusses digital literacy as a separate barrier altogether.
- B) The passage specifically attributes these agents to microfinance institutions, not government-run banks, so this reverses what's actually stated.
- D) The passage frames documentation requirements as a barrier to inclusion, not something these agents are enforcing more strictly.

**Q13:** The relationship between the second and third paragraphs of the passage can best be described as

- A) the third paragraph lists structural barriers first introduced in the second paragraph
- B) the third paragraph contradicts the claims made in the second paragraph
- C) the third paragraph outlines consequences and a contrasting effect, building on causes described in the second paragraph
- D) the third paragraph is entirely unrelated to the content of the second paragraph

**Correct Answer: C) the third paragraph outlines consequences and a contrasting effect, building on causes described in the second paragraph**

**Explanation:** The second paragraph explains the structural causes behind financial exclusion, while the third paragraph shifts to the consequences of that exclusion and then pivots with "conversely" to describe the positive effects of inclusion, building logically on what came before.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) The third paragraph discusses consequences and effects, not a repeated list of the same structural barriers already covered in the second paragraph.
- B) The third paragraph doesn't contradict anything stated earlier, it extends the discussion by showing what results from the barriers already described.
- D) The two paragraphs are closely connected, since the third builds directly on the causes established in the second rather than existing independently.

**Q14:** Based on the passage, which is most accurately supported?

- A) Rural women's share of the unbanked roughly matches their share of the rural population.
- B) Roughly a third of adults in developing economies are unbanked, with rural women disproportionately represented.
- C) The unbanked figure stems equally from documentation gaps and network issues alone.
- D) Digital literacy gaps outweigh distrust from exploitative lending as a cause of exclusion.

**Correct Answer: B) Roughly a third of adults in developing economies are unbanked, with rural women disproportionately represented.**

**Explanation:** The passage states nearly a third of adults in developing economies remain unbanked, and specifically notes rural women make up a disproportionate share of that group, so this statement pulls both facts directly from the text.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) The passage says rural women's share is disproportionately large, not roughly equal to their general population share, so this understates the disparity.
- C) The passage lists several distinct barriers beyond just documentation and network issues, so narrowing it to only these two misrepresents the range of causes given.
- D) The passage never ranks these barriers against each other, it lists them alongside one another without indicating which one matters more.

**Q15:** A veteran surgeon performs a \_\_\_\_\_ procedure guided by \_\_\_\_\_ imaging and retains a/an \_\_\_\_\_ composure even when complications arise mid-operation without warning.

- A) precise / definitive / unflinching
- B) meticulous / conclusive / stoic
- C) exacting / corroborative / imperturbable
- D) methodical / irrefutable / resolute

**Correct Answer: C) exacting / corroborative / imperturbable**

**Explanation:** Exacting means demanding great care and precision, corroborative imaging means scans that back up or confirm each other rather than standing alone, and imperturbable means someone who stays completely calm no matter what happens, which fits a surgeon handling sudden complications without losing composure.

**Why the other options are wrong:**

- A) Definitive means something that settles things once and for all, but imaging during surgery is meant to support other findings, not close the case by itself.
- B) Conclusive has the same problem as definitive here, it suggests the imaging proves something completely on its own instead of working together with other checks.
- D) Irrefutable means impossible to argue against, which fits a strong claim or fact, not imaging that keeps getting checked and rechecked during an ongoing procedure.